- The Subject of the Active Verb is made the object of some Preposition (generally 'by').
- The Verb of the Active Voice must have the Past Participle form of the Finite Verb.
- The tense of the Verb does not change.
- Only Transitive verbs can be changed into Passive Voice.
- When the verbs expressing command, order, advice or request are changed into Passive Voice, 'Let' is placed at the beginning of the subject. Also place 'Passive Infinitive' without 'to' after 'be'. The form of the Passive Voice will be – Let + Subject + be +Verb in third form. Subject is placed between 'Let' and 'be' + verb in third form.
- While changing Present Infinitive into Passive Voice, put 'to + be + verb in third form' (Past Participle in place of infinitive form) **e.g.** A letter has to be posted by me.
- Some vague and indefinite subjects like 'everyone', 'they', 'people', 'someone', 'somebody,' everybody', 'anybody', etc., are dropped when the sentence is changed into Passive Voice. e.g : Prizes were distributed at the end of the function.
- The use of 'by' is considered superfluous when the special interest of the speaker is not in the active subject but in the predicate. For example – 'French is spoken in many parts of the world'.
- 'They say' can be changed into 'It is said'.

Sentences with the following four tenses of verbs cannot be transformed into Passive Voice.

- Present Perfect Continuous

  E.g. Anita has been playing squash since childhood.
- Past Perfect Continuous

  E.g. My family had been running textile business for years.
- Future Continuous

  E.g. Students will be giving dance performance tomorrow.
- Future Perfect Continuous

  E.g. They will have been discussing the sensitive issues for five days.

Task 1

Change the following sentences into Passive Voice.

a. The Governor inaugurated the exhibition at ten o' clock.

b. The crowd expected their leader to arrive early in the morning.

c. Who taught her Computer Science?

d. They unanimously named Ravi the captain of team.

e. The President gave the commander an award.

f. Do not tell a lie.

g. Please open the door.

h. It is time to stop the work.

i. They say he is a spy.

j. One should keep one's promise.

k. People burn a great deal of wood in winter.

l. Where had you kept the book?

12th General_English_Unit_3_A_Prose.indd 77 13-02-2020 16:38:05